

ISSUE No. XIII

17 AUGUST 29, 2026

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ISSUE No. XIII

17 AUGUST 29, 2026

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No. I can survive well enough on my own—if given the proper reading material.

-SARAH J. MAAS

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THE HINDU

17 AUGUST 29, 2026

ELECTORAL REFORMS & GOVERNANCE

Unkind cuts: On the Telangana and Karnataka electoral rolls

“Steepening and opaque voter deletions threaten universal franchise and demand immediate procedural transparency.”

17 August 29, 2026 • 3 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process being conducted by the Election Commission of India (ECI) is increasingly leading to a clear case of **disenfranchisement**⁰¹ in several parts of India. **Marauding on**⁰² after a judgment by the Supreme Court of India allowed it to proceed, the SIR has now **struck out**⁰³ a fifth of the names from the electoral rolls in Telangana and Karnataka — nearly 22% and 19.5% respectively — and among the highest in the country. The cuts are steepest in their capital cities — five constituencies in Bengaluru have lost more than half of their electors while nine of Hyderabad's 15 have seen deletions of more than 40%. Cuts of this kind cannot simply be a trimming of **bloated**⁰⁴ rolls at the margins⁰⁵. If they are accurate, the ECI's own summary revision processes were yielding **bloated**⁰⁴ rolls in recent elections, and doing so in the very places with high **in-migration**⁰⁶ from the rest of India. And if the deletions are to be justified, those **struck off**⁰⁷ the rolls must have left the States — a move within Karnataka or Telangana would only relocate a voter's name on the same State roll, not remove it altogether. Yet, this is neither **borne out**⁰⁸ by recent survey data nor by the government's own population estimates.

During the Bihar SIR, the Court asked why political parties had filed so few objections, seeking inclusion of wrongly deleted names; that question might hold true for the Southern States as well. A **plausible**⁰⁹ reason could be that the voter id is useful to a citizen only once in a few years, leading to less **electors**¹⁰ on their part. This may explain why a process that puts the **onus**¹¹ on electors yields cuts of this scale. Meanwhile, proving a **smoking gun**¹² in the data is difficult because of the ECI's **opacity**¹³. It has not published the elector-to-population ratio for any State so far during the revision even though doing so is **mandatory**¹⁴ and is the only test of under-enrolment. The Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer has not even bothered to release a gender-wise **breakdown**¹⁵ of the deletions, instead scattering the lists across several Google Drive links without the old booth numbers, making verification **arduous**¹⁶. The outcome of such **shoddiness**¹⁷ is visible in West Bengal, where the ECI's **dubious**¹⁸ “logical discrepancy” process **disenfranchised**¹⁹ lakhs of electors, forcing them to seek **redress**²⁰ before tribunals set up under the aegis of²¹ the Court. Months after the elections, records obtained under a Right to Information request show that barely 82,000 of the nearly 38 lakh appeals before the 19 tribunals have been decided, with more than 90% of those decisions favouring electors seeking **restoration**²². The ECI — an institution once **envied**²³ even by weather historians for bringing large numbers of Indians to the polling booth — is now an obstacle to universal adult **franchise**²⁴.

Source: The Hindu Published: August 29, 2026 12:20 AM IST

Today's Editorials Series • August 29, 2026

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Unkind cuts: On the Telangana and Karnataka electoral rolls

THE HINDU

ELECTORAL REFORMS & GOVERNANCE

EDITORIAL STANCE

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

WORDS

01	bloated ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अतिवृद्ध / फुल्ल हुआ Swollen or excessively enlarged beyond normal or desirable limits.	MEMORY HOOK Relate to a bloated stomach — unnaturally large, filled with unwanted excess.	SYNONYMS • inflated • overexpanded • distended	ANTONYMS • streamlined • trimmed • reduced
02	in-migration NOUN NEUTRAL	आंतरिक प्रवास The process of people moving into a new area or country to live permanently.	MEMORY HOOK "In" + "migrant" = people migrating into a specific region or state.	SYNONYMS • immigration • influx • inflow	ANTONYMS • outflow • exodus
03	plausible ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	संभावनीय / संतर्पित Reasonable, likely, or having the appearance of truth.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like "possible" and "appeal-worthy" — an explanation that makes genuine sense.	SYNONYMS • credible • feasible • convincing	ANTONYMS • implausible • unlikely • far-fetched
04	alertness ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	तत्परता / जूझ Brisk and cheerful readiness or promptness in response or action.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like "electricity" — acting with high energy, speed, and readiness.	SYNONYMS • promptness • swiftness • alert	ANTONYMS • reluctance • apathy • sluggishness
05	opacity NOUN NEGATIVE	अस्पष्टता The quality of being obscure, unclear, or difficult to see through or understand.	MEMORY HOOK Opaque glass blocks light; administrative opacity blocks public scrutiny.	SYNONYMS • obscurity • non-transparency • cloudiness	ANTONYMS • transparency • clarity • openness
06	breakdown NOUN NEUTRAL	वर्गीकरण / खंड An explanatory analysis or division of information into categorized parts.	MEMORY HOOK Breaking down large aggregated data into small, understandable categories.	SYNONYMS • classification • dissection • analysis	ANTONYMS • aggregation • consolidation • generalisation
07	arduous ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठिन / बलस्राव Involving or requiring strenuous effort, difficulty, and exhausting labour.	MEMORY HOOK Rhymes with "hard for us" — a task that demands strenuous physical or mental effort.	SYNONYMS • laborious • strenuous • onerous	ANTONYMS • effortless • easy • facile
08	shoddiness ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	परिश्रम / सावधानी The state or quality of being badly made, carelessly done, or of inferior standard.	MEMORY HOOK Think of a "shoddy" building made carelessly that collapses easily.	SYNONYMS • carelessness • shoddiness • inferiority	ANTONYMS • meticulousness • excellence • precision
09	dubious ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संदिग्ध Hesitating or doubting; not to be relied upon, or morally suspect.	MEMORY HOOK Relate to "doubt" — full of doubt and uncertainty.	SYNONYMS • suspicious • questionable • doubtful	ANTONYMS • trustworthy • reliable • indisputable
10	disenfranchised VERB NEGATIVE	नागरिकता हिन Deprived an individual or group of the right to vote or participate in governance.	MEMORY HOOK Past tense of disenfranchise — past action of stripping voting privileges.	SYNONYMS • disenfranchised • disfranchised • disqualified	ANTONYMS • enfranchised • empowered • admitted
11	envied VERB POSITIVE	ईर्ष्या का प्रभाव का प्रभाव Regarded with a feeling of admiration combined with a wish to possess the same quality.	MEMORY HOOK When others want what you have because it is prestigious, you are envied.	SYNONYMS • admired • coveted • esteemed	ANTONYMS • scorned • disdained • ridiculed

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • UNKIND CUTS: ON THE TELANGANA AND KARNATAKA ELECTORAL ROLLS

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

6 TERMS

01	disenfranchisement NOUN NEGATIVE	नागरिकता से वंचित करना The state of being deprived of the right to vote, especially the right to vote in elections.	MEMORY HOOK Dis (deprive) + franchise (right to vote) = stripping away voting rights.	SYNONYMS • disenfranchisement • disfranchisement • exclusion	ANTONYMS • enfranchisement • inclusion
02	onus NOUN	दायित्व / जिम्मेदारी का बोझ Something that is one's duty or responsibility to perform or prove.	MEMORY HOOK "On us" = The responsibility falls directly on us.	SYNONYMS • responsibility • liability • burden	ANTONYMS • immunity • exemption • relief
03	mandatory ADJECTIVE	अनिवार्य / बाध्यकारी Required by law, rule, or administrative mandate.	MEMORY HOOK Comes from "mandate" (an official command) — something that must be done.	SYNONYMS • compulsory • obligatory • requisite	ANTONYMS • optional • voluntary • discretionary
04	redress NOUN	विचार / प्रत्युत्तर Remedy or compensation for a wrong, injustice, or grievance suffered.	MEMORY HOOK Re-dress = to mend and fix a wound or wrong properly again.	SYNONYMS • reparation • rectification • redressal	ANTONYMS • perpetration • penalty • injury
05	restoration NOUN	पुनर्स्थापना The act of returning something to a former condition, place, or position.	MEMORY HOOK Restore + a = bringing something back to its original state.	SYNONYMS • reinstatement • reversion • re-establishment	ANTONYMS • revocation • abolition • disestablishment
06	franchise NOUN	नागरिकता The constitutional right to vote in public and political elections.	MEMORY HOOK From Old French "franc" (free) — the essential right of a free citizen.	SYNONYMS • suffrage • voting rights • ballot	ANTONYMS • disenfranchisement • disfranchisement • ineligibility

DIOMS & PHRASES

2 TERMS

01	at the margins PHRASE	किनारे पर / छोरों के किनारे पर Dealing with the margins, peripheral, or insignificant details rather than the core issue.	MEMORY HOOK Margins are the edges of a page; focusing on the margins means only minor, non-central changes.	SYNONYMS • peripherally • insignificantly • marginally	ANTONYMS • substantially • centrally • fundamentally
02	smoking gun NOUN	अस्पष्ट प्रमाण Incontestable evidence of a crime, malpractice, or other wrongdoing.	MEMORY HOOK A gun still smoking in someone's hand is indisputable proof of their firing it.	SYNONYMS • conclusive evidence • indisputable proof • unquestionable fact	ANTONYMS • inconclusive evidence • hearsay • presumption

DEFERRED RIVALRY: ON THE U.S. OPEN

17 AUGUST 29, 2026

SPORTS / TENNIS

Deferred rivalry: On the U.S. Open

“Injuries and fluctuating player form open new doors ahead of the year's final Grand Slam.”

17 August 29, 2026 • 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The Carlos Alcaraz-Jannik Sinner rivalry is no doubt this era's defining matchup, but it has also been **punctuated**⁰¹ by long pauses. In an early-related ban; this season, Alcaraz was out of action for four months from mid-April owing to a troublesome wrist. Just when it seemed that the two **leading lights**⁰² was **come face to face**⁰³ at the US Open starting Sunday, Sinner has been **waylaid**⁰⁴ by a knee injury. In 2025, they met six times in six months, the **postponement**⁰⁵ of the battle may suit Alcaraz, for the seven-time Major champion has not played a competitive singles fixture since Barcelona in April. The Spaniard has **warmed up for**⁰⁶ Flushing Meadows with two mixed doubles matches partnering the legendary Serena Williams, but a best-of-five-sets contest is a significant **step-up**⁰⁷. The 23-year-old will open against Roman Safiullin — a **tricky**⁰⁸ player who beat Alcaraz in 2023 on a Paris hard-court and reached the Wimbledon fourth round this year — and is **drawn to**⁰⁹ meet the In-form American Ben Shelton in the quarter-final. Potential semifinal opponents include 24-year-time Novak Djokovic and 2021 US Open winner Daniil Medvedev, which makes the defending champion's path challenging.

However, Djokovic and Medvedev are on their own tough journeys. The 39-year-old Serb is no longer the **once-renowned**¹⁰ hard-court master, and lost his lone match — in Cincinnati — after the semifinal **reverse**¹¹ to Sinner at Wimbledon. Medvedev was last in a Major final at the 2024 Australian Open and is without a trophy since February. Alexander Zverev thus has a golden opportunity to make his big **breakthrough**¹² on his favourite surface. Without Sinner, the German will be the top seed, and following the French Open triumph and Wimbledon runner-up finish, the 29-year-old will be **confidence personified**¹³. Among women, two-time defending champion Aryna Sabalenka would have liked to be that player, but the Belarusian World No. 1 has **wobbled**¹⁴ of **late**¹⁵ and seen her lead at the top cut to less than 450 points. Her chief challenger Elena Rybakina may be **racing against time**¹⁶ to recover from an ankle injury, but with Iga Swiatek, Coco Gauff and Jessica Pegula all in impressive form leading into New York, Sabalenka will have a **daunting**¹⁷ task. Wimbledon winner Linda Noskova will be looking for a **worthy**¹⁸ follow-up while the fast-rising 21-year-old from the Philippines, Alexandra Eala, will hope to continue her recent **eye-popping**¹⁹ run. With Serena and Venus Williams set to **pair up**²⁰ in doubles, there will be a rich sprinkling of **stardust**²¹ too.

Source: The Hindu Published: August 29, 2026 12:20 AM IST

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VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • DEFERRED RIVALRY: ON THE U.S. OPEN

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	postponement NOUN	विलंब / स्थगित The action of putting off something to a later time.	MEMORY HOOK Postpone + ment = shifting something to a 'post' (later) state.	SYNONYMS • deferral • adjournment • rescheduling	ANTONYMS • advancement • expediting • continuation
02	breakthrough NOUN	खंडन / सफलता / सफलता प्राप्त A sudden, major, or decisive advance or success.	MEMORY HOOK Breaking through a barrier that was stopping you from reaching the top.	SYNONYMS • milestone • triumph • leap forward	ANTONYMS • setback • stalemate • stagnation

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

1 TERM

01	drawn to VERB	मुकाबले के लिए नियमित होना To meet or scheduled to compete against an opponent in a tournament or future.	MEMORY HOOK In sports, names are 'drawn' from a lottery pot to decide who plays whom.	SYNONYMS • slated to meet • slated to play • paired with	ANTONYMS • exempted from • bypassed by • separated from
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PHRASAL VERBS

4 TERMS

01	punctuated by VERB	बीच-बीच में रुकना Interrupted or broken at intervals by something.	MEMORY HOOK Think of punctuation marks (commas, stops) that regularly interrupt the flow of a sentence.	SYNONYMS • interrupted by • broken up by • interspersed with	ANTONYMS • continuous with • sustained by
02	warmed up for VERB	पूरे मैचों के लिए तैयारी करना Prepared oneself for a major contest through preliminary activities.	MEMORY HOOK Warming up your body before a race to become ready for the main challenge.	SYNONYMS • geared up for • primed for	ANTONYMS • neglected • stood down from • unprepared for
03	pair up VERB	जोड़ी बनाना / साथ मिलकर खेलना To join together with another person to form a team or partnership.	MEMORY HOOK Forming a pair of two to work together as a single unit.	SYNONYMS • team up • join forces • collaborate	ANTONYMS • separate • disband • part ways

IDIOMS & PHRASES

6 TERMS

01	leading lights NOUN	प्रमुख व्यक्तित्व / मार्गदर्शक Prominent, respected, and influential persons in a particular field.	MEMORY HOOK The brightest lights at the front that lead and illuminate the way for others.	SYNONYMS • luminaries • trailblazers • stalwarts	ANTONYMS • nonentities • underdogs • followers
02	come face to face VERB	आपस-आपस में होना To meet or encounter someone directly in competition or conflict.	MEMORY HOOK Standing so close that both faces are directly looking at each other in a duel.	SYNONYMS • encounter directly • confront • clash with	ANTONYMS • avoid • steer clear of • evade
03	confidence personified NOUN	आत्मविश्वास का साक्षात् रूप A person who perfectly exemplifies or embodies total self-assurance.	MEMORY HOOK A person whose entire character represents pure, visible confidence.	SYNONYMS • embodiment of assurance • epitome of poise • avatar of certainty	ANTONYMS • self-doubt • difference personified • nervousness incarnate
04	of late ADVERB	हाल ही में In recent times or during the latest period.	MEMORY HOOK Refers to the 'most late' (recent) period of time.	SYNONYMS • recently • lately • in recent days	ANTONYMS • formerly • historically • long ago
05	racing against time VERB	समय की कमी से युद्ध करना Making great or hurried efforts to do something before a deadline.	MEMORY HOOK Running in a race against the ticking clock before time expires.	SYNONYMS • battling the clock • racing • hurrying	ANTONYMS • bidding one's time • difference personified • taking one's leisure
06	sprinkling of stardust NOUN	खतरा या जलवायु अचानक का प्रभाव A small amount of glamour, celebrity charm, or magical excitement.	MEMORY HOOK Sprinkling magical dust from celebrity stars onto an event to make it glamorous.	SYNONYMS • touch of glamour • dash of celebrity • aura of charm	ANTONYMS • drabness • ordinariness • mundanity

END OF TODAY'S EDITORIALS • PROCEED TO BACK COVER

17 AUGUST 29, 2026

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

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